THE MATERNITY METHOD

NCLEX CHEAT SHEET

Process of Labor & OB Procedures

Maternal & Newborn › Intrapartum

The Big Picture Labor works when **Powers** (contractions + pushing) move the **Passenger** (baby) through the **Passage** (pelvis + soft tissue), supported by mom's **Psyche** and **Position**. Know the **stages**, how baby is positioned, and the nursing care for each **procedure**.

KNOW THE NUMBERS

0	6 cm	10 cm	≤ 30 min	Every 15 min
Station: head at the ischial spines (engaged)	**Active** labor starts	**Complete**: stage 2 begins	Placenta delivery (**stage 3**)	VS + fundus in the **first hour** after birth

Stages of Labor

Stage	From → to	Nursing focus
1: Latent	Onset → **5 cm**; mild, irregular contractions	Walk, fluids, comfort; she's chatty and excited
1: Active	**6 → 10 cm**; stronger, regular	Pain relief, position changes, **void every 2 hrs**, monitor FHR
1: Transition	**8 → 10 cm**; intense	Nausea, shaking, "I can't do this": **stay close**, coach breathing, don't push yet
2: Pushing	**10 cm** → birth of baby	Coach pushing, check FHR after each contraction; **crowning**
3: Placenta	Baby → **placenta** (≤ 30 min)	Signs of separation: **gush of blood, cord lengthens, uterus rises and turns globular**
4: Recovery	**1–4 hrs** after placenta	**Fundus, lochia, VS every 15 min** for the first hour; bonding, first feed

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Baby's Position Terms

- **Lie:** baby's spine vs. mom's: **longitudinal** (normal) or transverse
- **Presentation:** part entering the pelvis first: **cephalic**, breech, shoulder
- **Attitude: flexion** (chin to chest) is best
- **Position:** e.g., **LOA** (left occiput anterior) is ideal
- **Station:** −5 to +5; **0 = engaged**

Rupture of Membranes

- **Check FHR right away**: **cord prolapse** risk
- **COAT:** Color, Odor, Amount, Time
- Clear/straw = normal · **green** = meconium · cloudy/foul = infection · port-wine = abruption
- Confirm: **nitrazine turns blue** (alkaline), **fern**ing under microscope

MEMORY HACK · CARDINAL MOVEMENTS

How baby turns through the pelvis: "Every Diva Flexes In Every Exciting Exit"

Engagement	Descent	Flexion	Internal rotation	Extension + External rotation + Expulsion
head reaches the spines	moves down	chin to chest	turns face-down	head out, turns, body follows

OB Procedures

Procedure	Why	Nursing care
Amniotomy (AROM)	Start or speed up labor	**FHR before and after**; COAT; temp every 2 hrs (infection); watch for cord prolapse
Induction / Bishop score	Bishop rates how **ready** the cervix is	**≥ 8 = favorable**; low score → ripen first (dinoprostone, misoprostol, balloon)
Amnioinfusion	Cushion the cord for **variable decels**	Warmed NS/LR through **IUPC**; watch **resting tone** and fluid **leaking out**
Vacuum / forceps	Help with pushing	Newborn: **cephalohematoma**, caput, bruising, facial nerve; mom: tears, bleeding
Episiotomy	Enlarge the opening	Pain relief, ice, **REEDA**, infection signs
External version (ECV)	Turn a breech baby (about **37 wks**)	**NST before/after**, tocolytic; **RhoGAM** if Rh−
Epidural	Pain relief	**IV fluids**, BP checks (**hypotension**), left tilt, **bladder** care, fall precautions
Cesarean	Safer delivery when needed	Consent, NPO, **Foley**, antacid, **antibiotic within 60 min** before incision, SCDs, left tilt

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RED FLAGS · STOP AND CALL THE PROVIDER

Bradycardia or deep decels after ROM · **Green or foul** fluid · **Contractions > 5 in 10 min** · **Placenta not out** in 30 min · **Heavy bleeding** in stage 4

MUST-KNOW FOR THE NCLEX

- **Check FHR immediately after membranes rupture.**
- **Station 0** = engaged at the ischial spines.
- Active labor begins at **6 cm**; **transition** (8–10 cm) is the hardest part.
- **Placenta separation:** gush of blood, cord lengthens, uterus rises and becomes globular.
- **Epidural → watch for hypotension** and a full bladder.

QUICK CHECK · TEST YOURSELF

1. The first nursing action after membranes rupture is to _____.
2. Nitrazine paper turns _____ with amniotic fluid.
3. The fetal head at the ischial spines = station ___.
4. A Bishop score of ___ or more means the cervix is favorable for induction.
5. Name 2 signs the placenta has separated.

Answers: 1. check the fetal heart rate · 2. blue · 3. 0 · 4. 8 · 5. gush of blood, cord lengthens, uterus rises/becomes globular

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